Portfolio

ALEXANDER KIM

stuff I build, code, draw and design

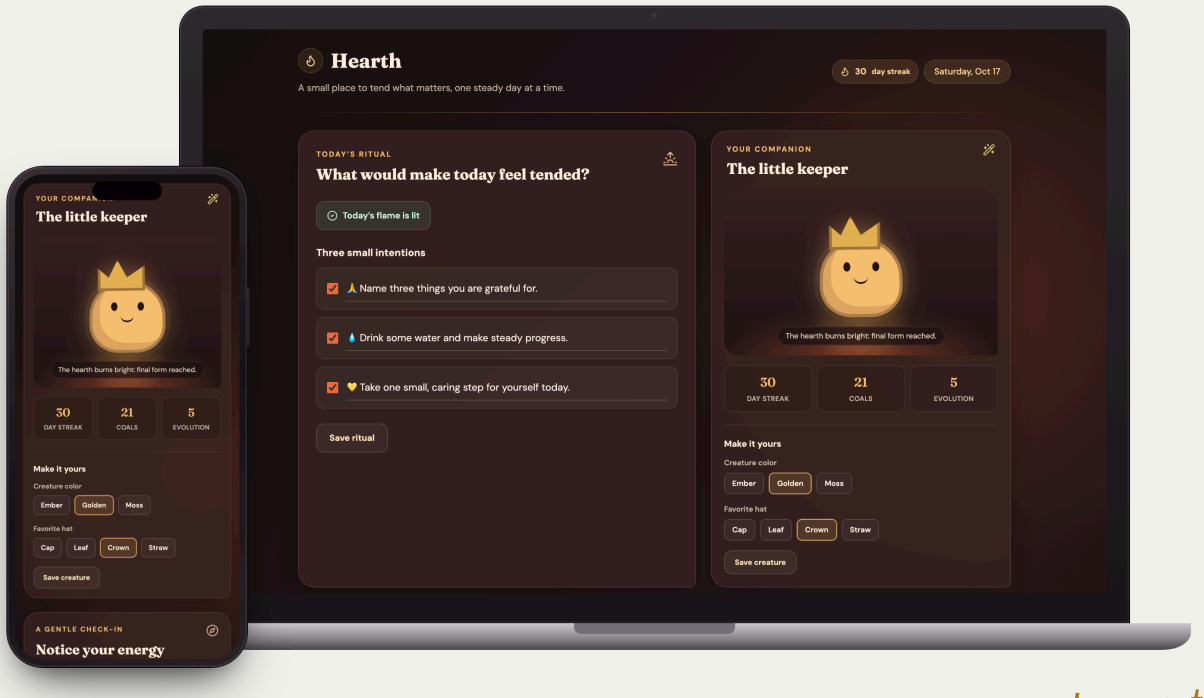
02 Hearth (app)
06 Meet the crew
08 LEGO Virtual Portfolio
10 The Lobby
12 Mercedes SL63
14 Poppin' Matcha Ads
17 The Fort
19 Music Production
05 Go-Kart Build
07 Go-Kart World
09 Wheelie Ride
11 The Woven Room
13 Poppin' Matcha Booth
15 Alex & Mr. Fishy
18 Birdhouse & Glider
20 Encanto



THIS EDITION · THE VEIL

After The Broad in Los Angeles: its honeycomb veil, El Anatsui's metal that hangs like cloth, and the shiny sculptures. Through the window: my Woven Room.

HEARTH



no ads, no tracking!

3
INTENTIONS A DAY

28
DAYS TO THE FINAL FORM

0
DATA COLLECTED

Alexander Kim

Hearth, *a wellness app that grows with you*

App · designed and coded by directing an Agent coding tool

WHAT IT IS

Hearth is a wellness app built around a daily ritual: each morning it asks “What would make today feel tended?” and you set three small intentions. A quick check-in on your mood, energy and stress shapes kinder goals, an “I’m feeling” page suggests ways to cope, and you get a companion that grows with your streak.

MY ROLE

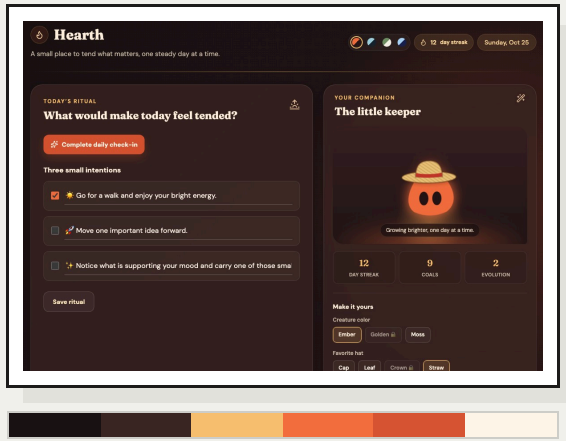
I was the designer and coder: I came up with the idea, designed every screen and feature, and coded it by directing an Agent coding tool for the OC Student AI Network.

WHY I INCLUDED IT

Like a lot of students, I juggle assignments, deadlines and social pressure, and I wanted a calm way to take each day one step at a time. I noticed a lot of people make games, so I wanted to make something that stood out and could actually help.

COLORS THAT MATCH YOUR MOOD

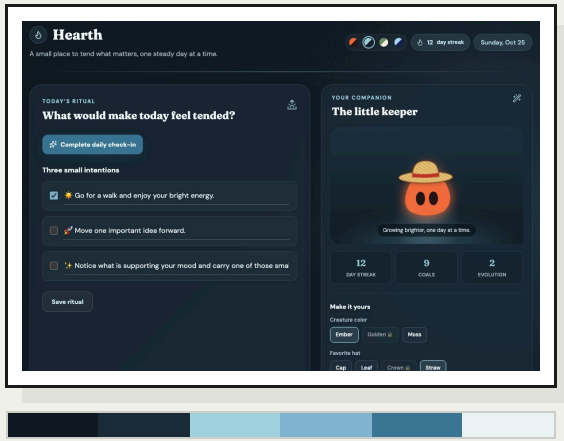
Colors change how people feel, so I designed four calm themes you can switch between depending on your mood. Each one comes from a place or memory that makes me feel calm.



EMBER

cozy + comforting

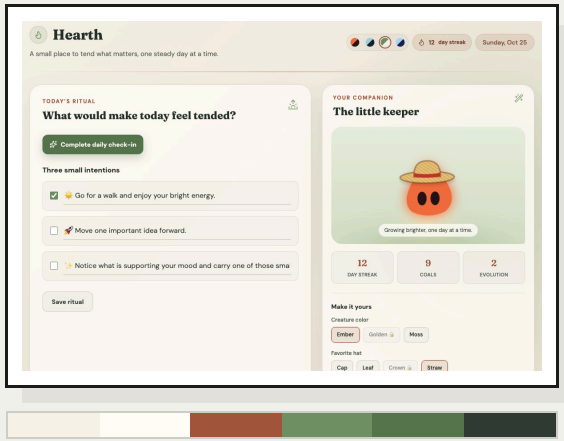
From camping trips with my mom, where the campfire is one of the most comforting feelings I know.



TIDEPOOL

serene + connected

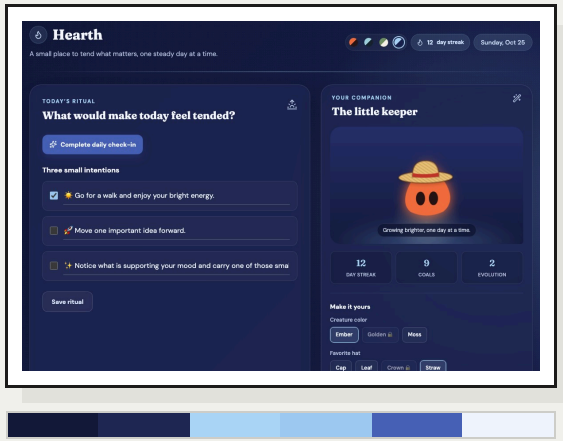
From exploring tide pools as a kid, where every animal was relaxed and the ecosystem worked as one.



MORNING MEADOW

fresh + hopeful

From mornings lying in the grass under a blue sky, with nowhere to be and a whole new day ahead.



MARSHY

soft + safe

From Marshy, my sequined midnight-blue sheep, who kept me company on the darkest nights.

TURNING PROBLEMS INTO SOLUTIONS

1

THINK

I sat down and asked myself what tool could make the world better and isn't out there enough.

2

OUTLINE

I wrote the main outline: a daily check-in, three goals, and a creature that grows.

3

BUILD

I built it by prompting an Agent coding tool, one feature at a time.

4

TEST & FIX

I tested each part, and when something broke I found another way.

WHAT DIDN'T WORK, AND WHAT I DID ABOUT IT

The app wouldn't load

My first version wouldn't run at all.

Fix: I loaded it on a personal account, and it worked.

FIXED

The Agent got stuck on goals

It kept misreading the goals feature and handing back the same broken answer, no matter how I prompted it.

Fix: I turned the problem into the solution: a goal tracker you set up yourself with short surveys.

FIXED

The shop locks free hats

The Agent decided you have to buy the free hats for your creature.

Fix: Still working on it, and it's next on my list.

IN PROGRESS

GO-KART BUILD

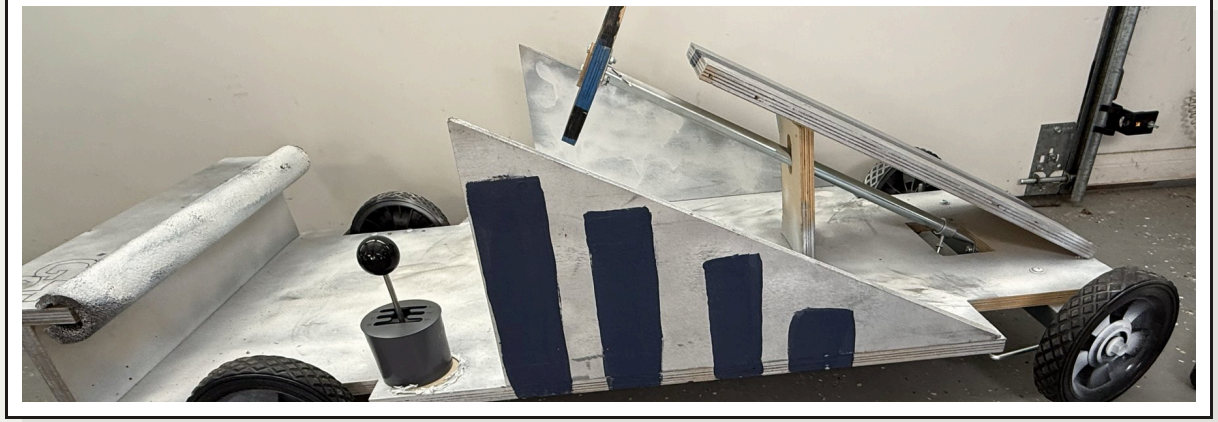


fig. 1 *the finished kart*

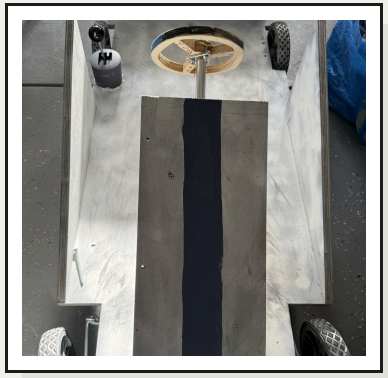


fig. 3 *1 · the frame*



fig. 4 *2 · paint + stripes*



fig. 5 *3 · stick shifter!*



fig. 2 *GTR = the car name*

Alexander Kim 05

Go-Kart Build, *Brian's Skyline, at go-kart scale*

Plywood frame, paint, stick shifter

WHAT IT IS

This summer I went to a go-kart camp and built my own kart.

MY ROLE

I built the frame, added a stick shifter, and painted it. My favorite car is the Nissan Skyline, so I based the look on Brian's Skyline from Fast & Furious: silver with blue stripes, plus blue underglow lights to make it more realistic.

WHY I INCLUDED IT

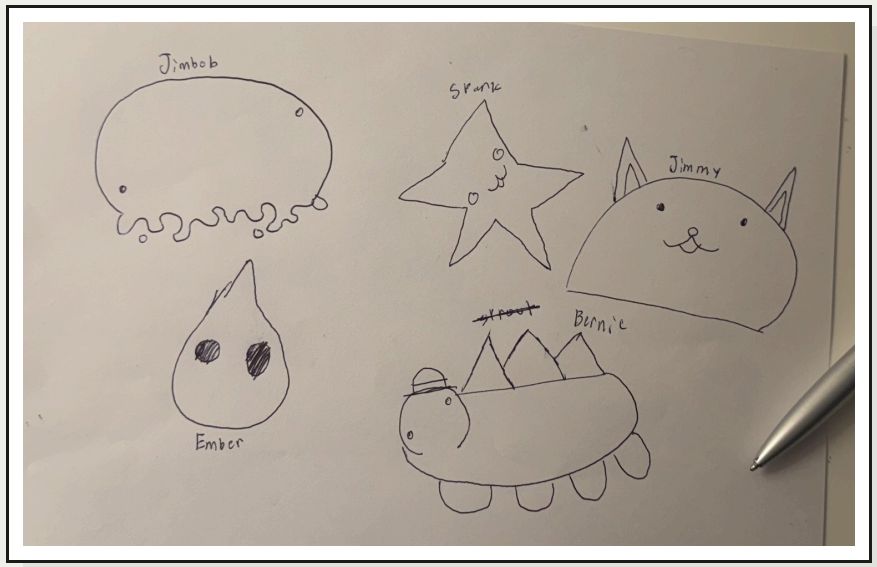
It's the first real vehicle I've built, and it's what inspired my racing game.

THE SKYLINE LOOK

Silver body · Navy stripes · Blue underglow

MEET THE CREW

Jimbob, Srank, Jimmy, Ember and Bernie are five characters I invented and first drew in pen on paper. I turned each sketch into a 3D character, then tried every one in three looks inspired by cartoons and games I studied. I included them to show my process: how a quick doodle grows into a finished character without losing what made the drawing special. They're the racers in my go-kart game.



Bernie was almost named Sprout. It's still crossed out!



GO-KART WORLD



fig. 1 *my crew, drawn by hand, on the grid*



fig. 2 *Brian's Skyline*



fig. 3 *drifting past the crew*

Alexander Kim 07

Go-Kart World, *my real kart, now a game*

3D racing game · browser + VR headset

WHAT IT IS

I'm really into racing games, so I made a 3D racing game inspired by the go-kart I built and the Crazy Cart I'm customizing.

MY ROLE

I drew the characters by hand, then built the game in Visual Studio Code using an agent orchestration harness with the Opus 5.5 model. I added different modes, a drift track and details like sponsor banners inspired by real racing brands, plus Brian's Skyline turning on a stand in the middle.

WHY I INCLUDED IT

It shows how I turn something I built in real life into something people can play.

MODES + FEATURES

RACE THE CREW | FREE DRIVE | DRIFT POINTS | NIGHT | 4 CAMERAS | VR | RACE HUD

LEGO VIRTUAL PORTFOLIO



fig. 1 *I shot them at street level so they look real*











fig. 3 *now you drive it*

fig. 2 *the virtual circuit, brick built*

Alexander Kim 08

LEGO Virtual Portfolio, *same orange car, now you drive it*

LEGO bricks, street-level photography, 3D race circuit

WHAT IT IS

I built two LEGO F1 cars and photographed them outside at street level, so they look like real race cars.

MY ROLE

Then I used them to design a virtual portfolio: a LEGO-scale 3D race track where you drive my orange car and pull in to see each project.

WHY I INCLUDED IT

It shows how something I built with my hands became the idea for a bigger digital world.

WHEELIE RIDE



fig. 1 *version 1 · one straight road*

15,900
REAL ROADS

104,600
REAL BUILDINGS

15 × 21 km
OF MY REAL MAP

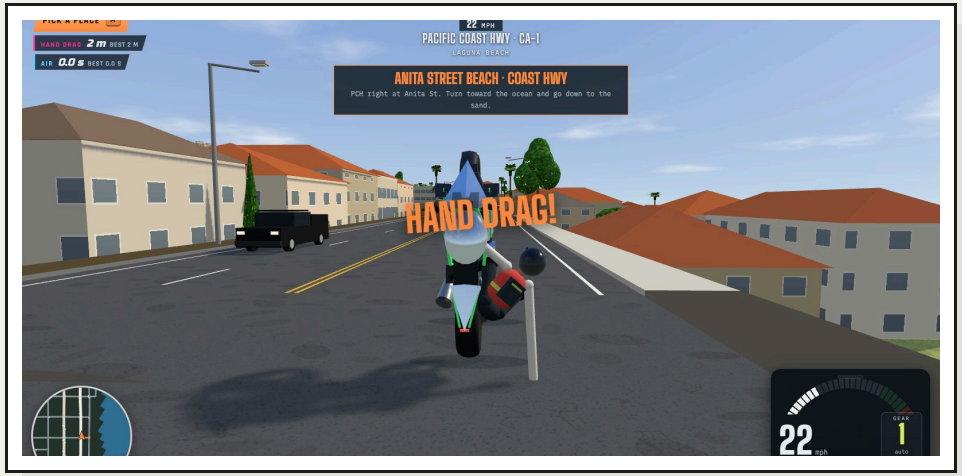


fig. 2 *version 2 · my neighborhood in Orange County*



fig. 3 *click a road to ride there*

Alexander Kim 09

Wheelie Ride, *from one straight road to my real neighborhood*

3D game · real OpenStreetMap data

WHAT IT IS

A 3D game where you pick a bike and hold a wheelie as long as you can without looping out. Version 1 was one straight road, so for Version 2 I rebuilt it in my own Orange County neighborhood with real map data.

MY ROLE

I designed and built both versions, and I wrote down every problem and fix in a release log.

WHY I INCLUDED IT

It shows how I keep improving my projects after version 1.

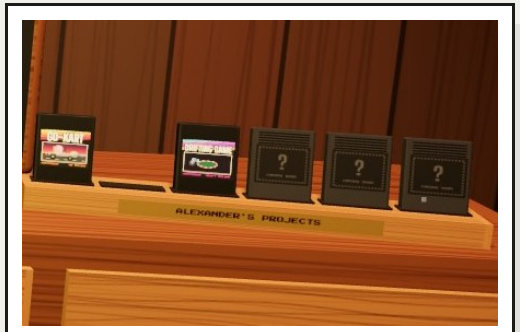
WHAT I LEARNED (FROM MY RELEASE LOG)

1. **Test your data, not just your code.** The ocean came out as dry land because the elevation data said the sea was 0 m high, same as a beach.
2. **Faking movement is easy until you want to go somewhere.** A real position and heading made maps, traffic and landmarks possible.
3. **Always test the extremes.** I only found a camera bug by testing the fastest bike.

THE LOBBY



fig. 1 *my projects, as game cartridges*



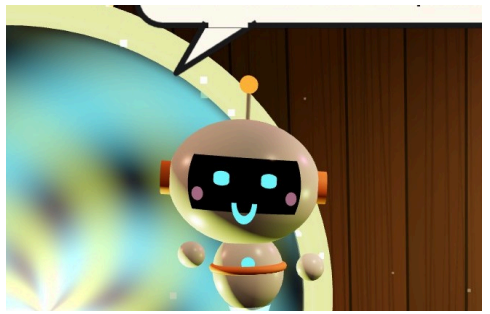
1 Pick a cartridge

Every project is a cartridge on the rack. The "?" slots are for games I haven't made yet.



2 Plug it in

The ALEX-2600 console plays the game's title screen on the TV.



3 Step through

Bit tells you about the game, then a portal opens straight into it.

Alexander Kim 10

The Lobby, *my projects, as game cartridges*

3D / VR experience · browser + headset

WHAT IT IS

A 3D game room for all my projects. Each project is a game cartridge you plug into my ALEX-2600 console, then you step through a portal into the game. Bit, a little robot, shows you around.

MY ROLE

I sketched this concept to showcase my work, then turned it into a 3D experience you can explore in a browser or a VR headset.

WHY I INCLUDED IT

I love the idea of a gaming system that plays the games I'm building, with a virtual robot as your guide.

THE WOVEN ROOM

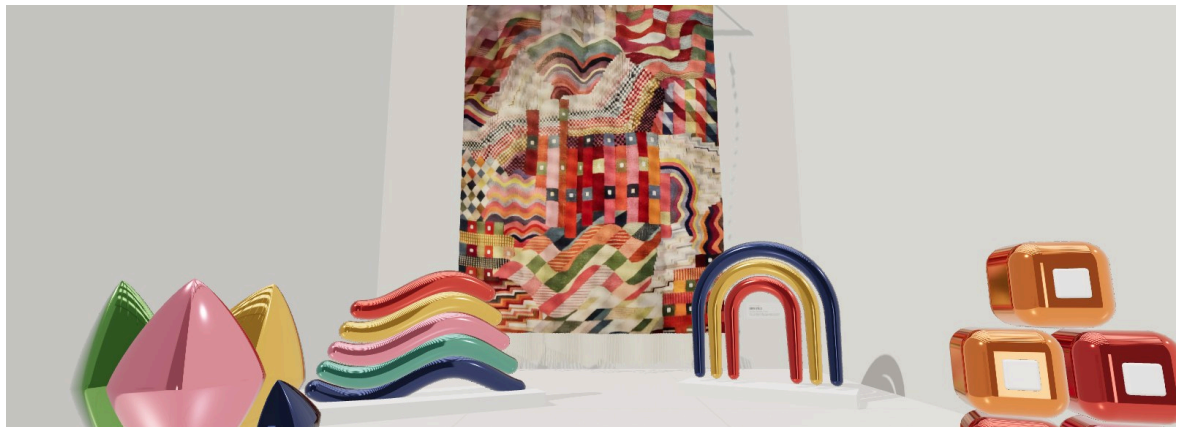


fig. 1 *from the door*



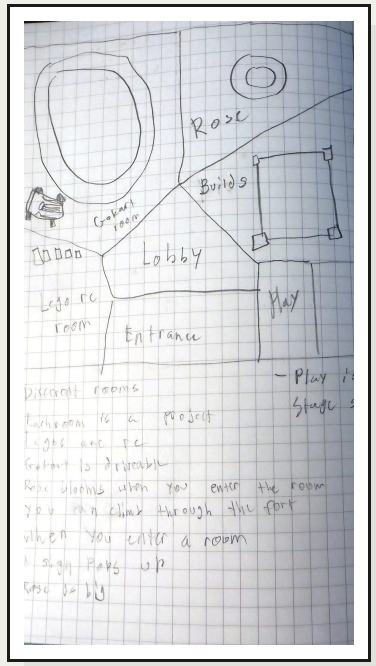
fig. 2 *Metal mode: thread becomes plates*



fig. 3 *sculptures pulled from the weave*

Tapestry: Gunta Stölzl, Slit Tapestry Red-Green, 1927/28, from a book photo.

NEXT ROOM



THE ROSE

In my gallery plan, the Rose room comes next: a rose that blooms when you enter the room, inspired by the rose I saw at Dataland.

my notebook plan

Alexander Kim 11

The Woven Room, *solid, but it moves*

VR gallery room · browser + headset

WHAT IT IS

A white gallery room you can walk through in a VR headset or a browser. Gunta Stölzl's 1927/28 Bauhaus tapestry fills the wall, hung in deep folds, with four mirror-shiny sculptures pulled from its shapes.

MY ROLE

I flattened a book photo of the tapestry so it could hang as a texture, folded it, added a Metal switch that turns the thread into little tilted metal plates, and shaped the sculptures from its wave, arch, window and diamond patterns.

WHY I INCLUDED IT

At The Broad I saw El Anatsui's wall piece: metal bottle caps that drape like cloth. It was solid, but it looked fluid, and I wanted to bring that into VR, where you can walk right up to it and watch the light move across the folds.

MERCEDES SL63

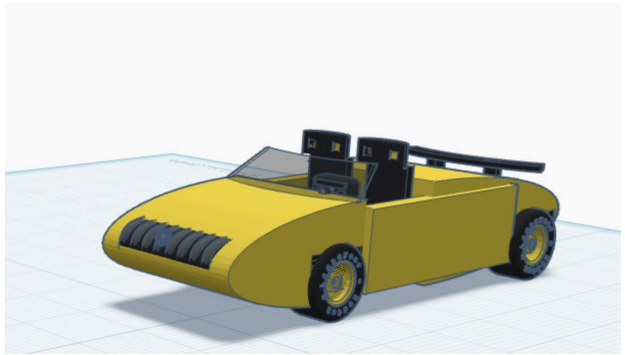


fig. 1 *view 1 · three-quarter*

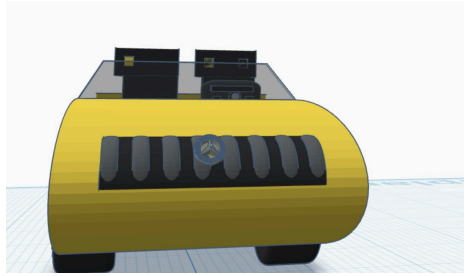


fig. 2 *view 2 · front*

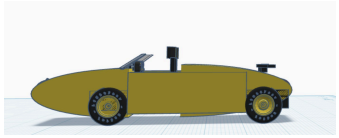


fig. 4 *view 4 · side*

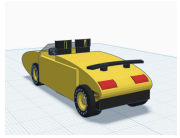


fig. 3 *view 3 · rear*

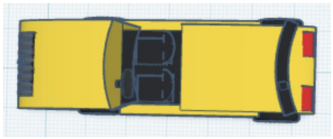


fig. 5 *view 5 · top*

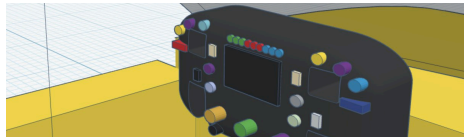


fig. 6 *even the wheel has buttons!*

Alexander Kim 12

Mercedes SL63, *built from simple shapes*

3D model in Tinkercad

WHAT IT IS

This is my 3D model of the Mercedes-AMG SL63, a famous roadster, made in Tinkercad.

MY ROLE

I'm a big fan of cars and I like designing in Tinkercad, so I made this as practice and as a 3D model for a game I'm making. I built it from simple shapes, down to the seats, the grille, the wheels and a steering wheel full of buttons.

WHY I INCLUDED IT

It shows my sense of scale and design, how I assemble a model from parts, and how I'm learning spatial awareness.

MODEL Mercedes-AMG SL63	TOOL Tinkercad
DRAWN BY Alexander Kim	FOR my racing game

POPPIN' MATCHA BOOTH

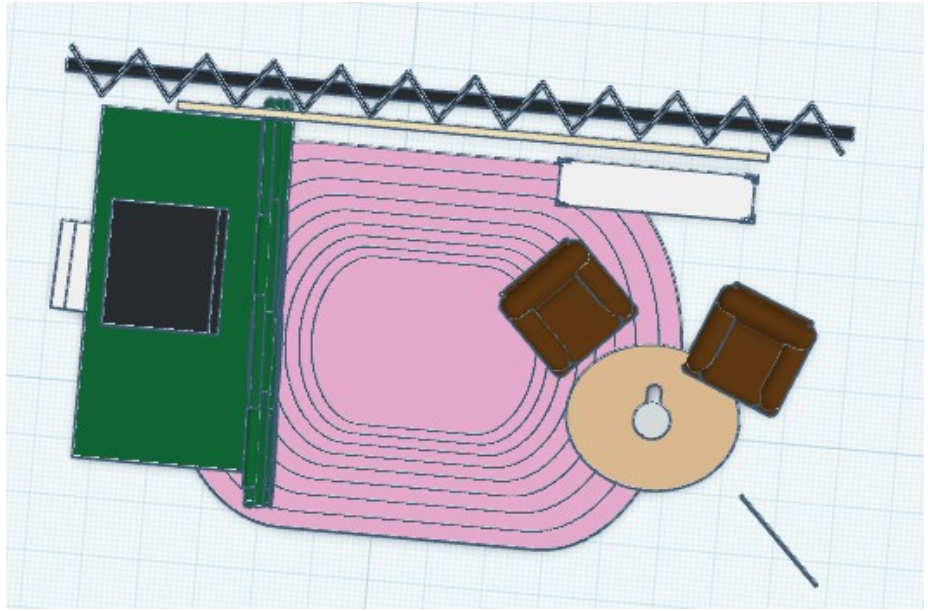


fig. 1 *plan: back wall, counter + screen, rug, lounge chairs, table*

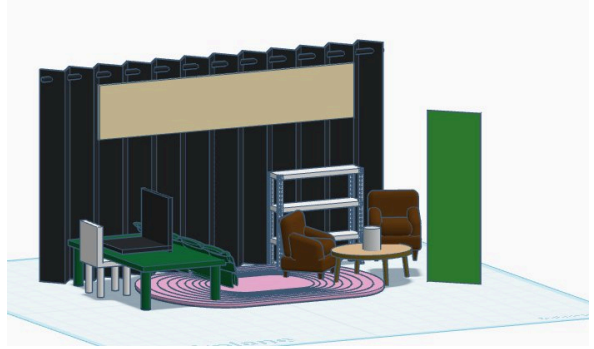


fig. 2 *front*

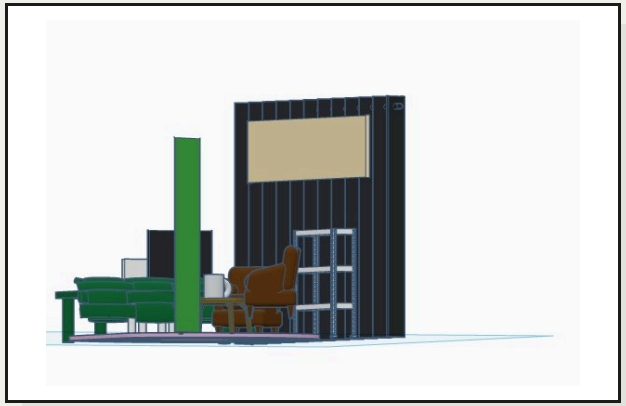


fig. 3 *side*

Alexander Kim

13

Poppin' Matcha Booth, *a real space, designed in CAD*

CAD booth design for a class company

WHAT IT IS

This is a booth I designed in CAD for Poppin' Matcha, the company my 7th and 8th grade class ran for Virtual Enterprises Junior Ventures.

MY ROLE

I was a Senior Manager in Marketing, responsible for ads and promotions.

WHY I INCLUDED IT

It shows how I design real-world environments in CAD, from the back wall and shelves to the lounge chairs and rug.

MY TEAM ROLE

SENIOR MANAGER, MARKETING

POPPIN' MATCHA ADS

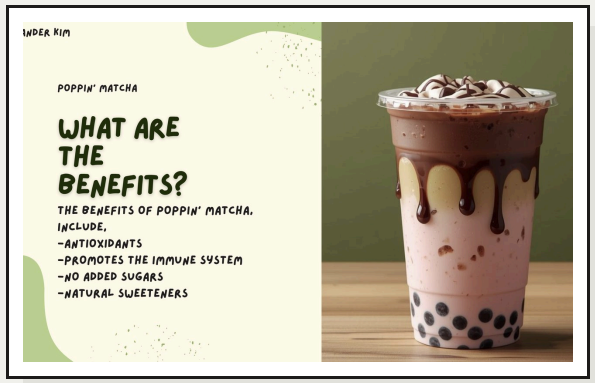


fig. 1 *web banner*



fig. 2 *slides from our marketing plan*





OUR BRAND MISSION

a boba with healthy benefits that still keeps its flavor



fig. 3 *vertical video ad*

Alexander Kim 14

Poppin' Matcha Ads, *a boba with healthy benefits that still keeps its flavor*

Canva · web banner, vertical video ad, slides

WHAT IT IS

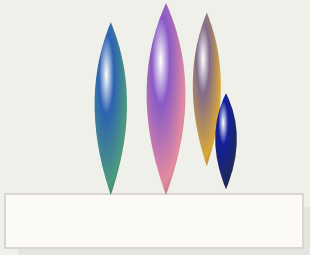
These are ads and promotions for Poppin' Matcha: a web banner, a vertical video ad and slides from our marketing plan.

MY ROLE

My role was helping create ideas for them. I used Canva, starting with templates and then customizing them for our brand.

WHY I INCLUDED IT

It shows graphic design for a brand our class built together as a team.



ALEX & MR. FISHY

Alex & Mr. Fishy is my cartoon series. In every episode, Mr. Fishy gets into a mess and learns something with help from his friend Alex. I picked frames from each cartoon and laid them out as storyboards.

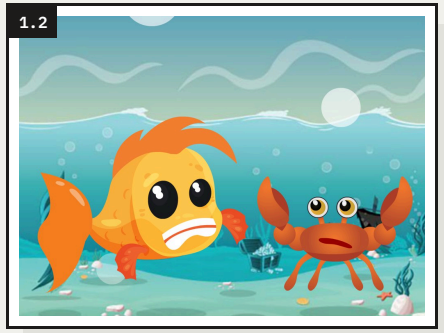
EPISODE 1

FREAK OUT

A storm is coming and Mr. Fishy is scared. His friend Alex comes along and helps him discover he can trust that everything will be OK, and he can ride the waves.



Title card: a giant wave is coming!



Mr. Fishy freaks out about the storm.



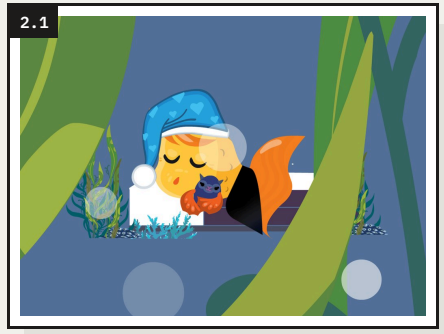
With Alex's help, he rides the waves.

everything will be OK!

EPISODE 2

WAKE UP

Mr. Fishy and Alex help a school of fish rebuild their home after they made a mess "messing around." Brick by brick, they build it back up together.



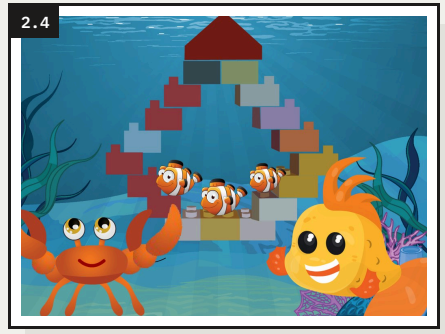
Mr. Fishy is fast asleep.



His friends need him to wake up.



The fish's home is a mess of bricks.



Brick by brick, they build it back up together.



LERY 16 —— ALEX & MR. FISHY · EPISODES 3 + 4

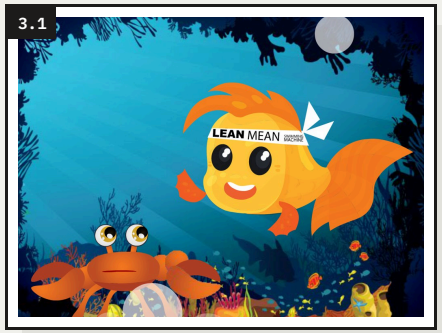
THE BIG RACE

Rocky Bal Beta was our real pet betta fish. Episode 3 ends with a card in his memory.

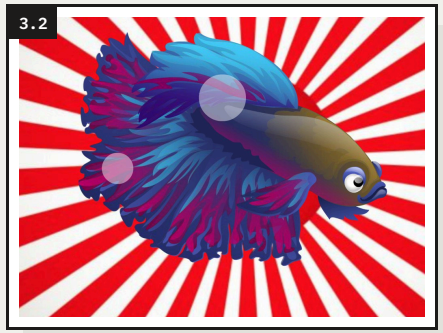
EPISODE 3

RACE

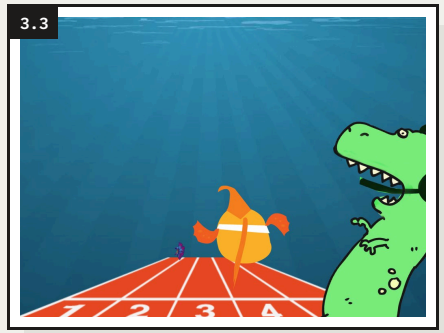
Mr. Fishy is sure he's the best and can win his race without training. He goes up against Rocky Bal Beta, who was our pet betta fish in real life. He loses, and learns that he needs to put the work in and practice humility.



Mr. Fishy, the "lean mean swimming machine."



His rival: Rocky Bal Beta.



Race day: he falls way behind.

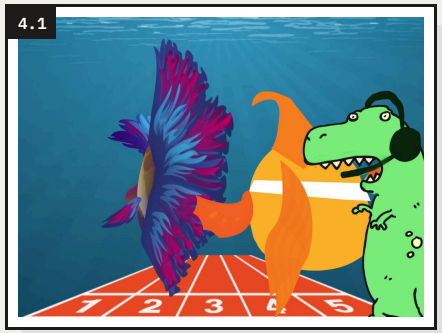


Time to put the work in.

EPISODE 4

STRONGER

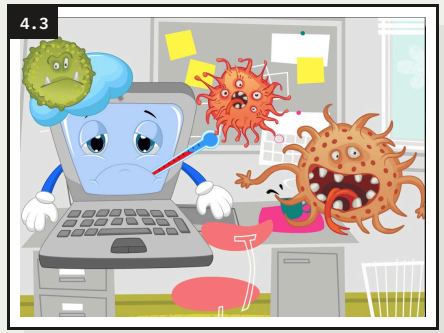
Mr. Fishy worked hard with Alex to get ready for the race, and he gets a rematch, with a lot of chaos.



The rematch!



Breaking news: "Banana Pants" interrupts the Tour de Fish.



A virus makes the computer sick.



And the chaos keeps coming.

THE FORT



fig. 1 *posts hold the floor off the ground*



fig. 2 *me + my brother*



fig. 3 *we decorated it!*

Alexander Kim 17

The Fort, *built with my brother*

Wood posts, boards and nails

WHAT IT IS

At a camp I went to with my brother, we built a fort out of wood.

MY ROLE

We used posts for the frame, built the first floor above the ground using nails, built the walls, added a roof, and then decorated it. My role was assembling the fort.

WHY I INCLUDED IT

It's where I got my experience building with wood.

HOW WE BUILT IT

1
POSTS
for the frame

2
FLOOR
nailed together, above the ground

3
WALLS
built and nailed on

4
ROOF
added on top

5
DECORATE
made it ours

BIRDHOUSE & GLIDER



fig. 1 *1*



fig. 2 *2*



fig. 3 *3*



fig. 4 *4 · from bare wood to finished*



fig. 5 *the balsa-wood glider*

Alexander Kim 18

Birdhouse & Glider, *piece by piece*

Painted wood birdhouse · balsa-wood glider

WHAT IT IS

Building has always been one of my favorite things to do. These photos show me painting a wooden birdhouse and putting together a balsa-wood glider.

MY ROLE

I painted my own design on the birdhouse and assembled the glider piece by piece.

WHY I INCLUDED IT

These early projects are where my love of making things started, and they led to bigger builds like my fort and my go-kart.

MUSIC PRODUCTION

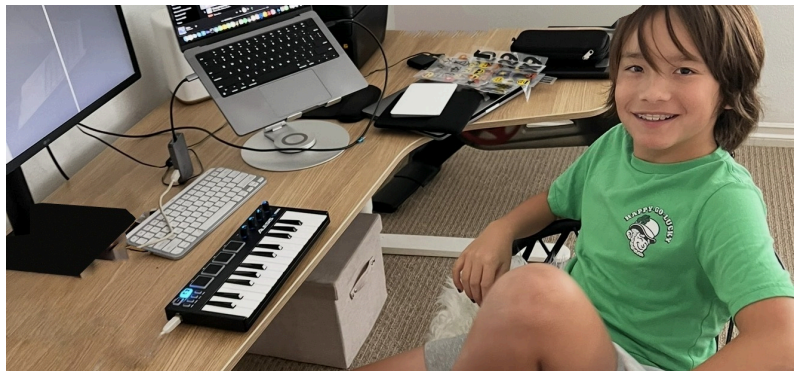


fig. 1 *my home studio*



fig. 2 *mixing live*

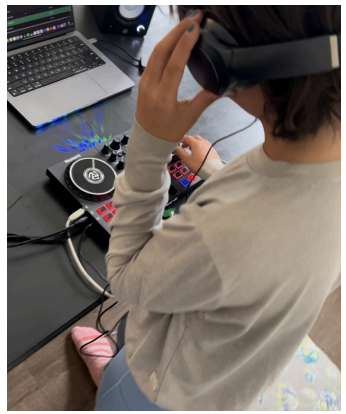




fig. 3 *talent show 2026*





fig. 4 *my act was on the program!*

Alexander Kim 19

Music Production, *the best part is when everyone starts dancing*

MIDI keyboard, laptop, DJ controller

WHAT IT IS

I love playing music. I make and mix music with my MIDI keyboard, my laptop and my DJ controller.

MY ROLE

I've created my own mixes, performed DJ mixing in my school talent show, and played at parties for my neighborhood.

WHY I INCLUDED IT

I like it when people are happy, dancing and enjoying music together.

WHERE I'VE PLAYED

TALENT SHOW 2026 | NEIGHBORHOOD PARTIES | HOME STUDIO

ENCANTO











Alexander Kim 20

Encanto, *next: designing the set!*

Youth musical theatre production

WHAT IT IS

Encanto was a youth musical theatre production I performed in, with a big cast, bright costumes and a painted set.

MY ROLE

I was part of the cast, singing and acting on stage alongside everyone else to bring the story to life.

WHY I INCLUDED IT

Being on stage showed me how much the set, costumes and lighting shape a story, and that's the side of theatre I want to learn next.